rated by folds of membrane, and united by commissures, or transverse bands of nervous matter. The gray and white matters are arranged in layers similar to the cerebrum; but it is a curious feature in the cerebellum, that when a vertical section of the mass is cut into and solidified by being frozen or otherwise, the white matter is found in the form of a well-defined tree, called from this appearance the *arbor vitæ*, or tree of life.

At the upper part of the spinal column is a singular bulb-shaped mass of white matter, called the medulla oblongata. It is situated immediately beneath the corpus callosum, between the right and left hemispheres of the cerebellum, and forms the point of union between the brain and spinal cord, although it properly belongs to the latter.

Its functions in the nervous system are complicated and important, so that anatomists assign it a very prominent position in the distribution of nerve-force.

Figs. 1 and 2, illustrating the brain, will give some idea of the divisions and subdivisions into which it is resolved; suffice to mention four, the functions of which are far more important than their diminutive size would seem to portend. The medulla oblongata is divided into two halves, like the spinal cord, and although these are transversed and united by bands of nerve-fibres, the functions of these columns are obviously different.

The anterior half of the medulla is the gate through which all the powers of motion are transmitted to the nerves throughout the body.

The posterior half of the medulla oblongata per-